Kenneth Anger was living in the **Los Angeles area** in January 1947 when the Black Dahlia murder occurred.

- **Location and Activity:** At the time of the murder, Anger was 19 years old and living in his parents' home in Beverly Hills. He was an active part of the local underground film and gay scenes and was attending the University of Southern California (USC) to study cinema.

- **The "Fireworks" Timeline:** During that same year, Anger filmed his most famous early work, *Fireworks* (1947), inside his parents' home while they were away for a funeral. The film itself features a dreamlike narrative of violence, including a scene where a man's chest is ripped open.

- **Connection to the Case:** While Anger has never been an official suspect; he later became one of the case's most famous "historians." He featured a graphic, uncensored photo of Elizabeth Short's body in his notorious book *Hollywood Babylon*, which helped cement the murder's status as a cult legend.

- **Marginal Suspect Links:** Some modern "Dahlia" theorists, such as Steve Hodel, have suggested that the killer was part of the same surrealist art circles (including figures like Man Ray) that Anger frequented and admired.

There is no evidence suggesting Anger was personally involved in the crime, but his proximity to the event and his subsequent obsession with it in his writing have kept his name associated with the lore of the case.

While there is no evidence that Kenneth Anger and the Zodiac Killer ever met, the theory that Anger's work or social circle could have **culturally influenced** the Zodiac is a fascinating "rabbit hole" explored by some true crime researchers. The potential connection usually centers on the **Occult, Cinema, and Symbolic Violence.**

1. The "Hollywood Babylon" Influence

Anger was the primary mythmaker of the Black Dahlia case. If the Zodiac was a "student" of California crime, he almost certainly read Anger's *Hollywood Babylon*.

- **The Graphic Element:** Anger was one of the first to publish the most gruesome, uncensored photos of Elizabeth Short.

- **The Theatrics:** The Zodiac was famously theatrical (the costume, the ciphers, the "slaves in paradise" mythology). Anger's work focused heavily on the **ritualization of violence** and the creation of a public persona, which mirrors the Zodiac's desire for infamy.

2. The Aleister Crowley Connection

Kenneth Anger was a devoted follower of Aleister Crowley and the "Thelema" philosophy. Interestingly, some researchers have noted "Crowley-esque" themes in the Zodiac's writings:

- **The Symbol:** The Zodiac cross-circle symbol has been compared by some to certain occult or astronomical sigils used in the magical circles Anger frequented.

- **The Motive:** The Zodiac claimed he was "collecting slaves for the afterlife." This type of idiosyncratic, quasi-religious motivation aligns with the dark occultism that Anger's films (like *Inauguration of the Pleasure Dome*) explored.

3. Shared Social Circles

If we look at the **"Man Ray / Surrealist"** theory:

- Steve Hodel (who suspects his father, George Hodel) argues that the Black Dahlia murder was a "surrealist art piece" inspired by the works of Man Ray.
- Kenneth Anger was a direct protégé and friend of many people in those same Los Angeles/San Francisco art circles.
- If the Zodiac was an older man (as some suspect) who moved in Northern California counter-culture or film circles in the 1960s, he would have likely encountered Anger's films or the underground "Magick" scene Anger spearheaded.

4. The "Lucifer Rising" Overlap

By the late 1960s—when the Zodiac was active—Kenneth Anger was living in San Francisco (The Embassy of thelema on Westerfeld Mansion).

- **Proximity:** Anger was filming *Lucifer Rising* in the Haight-Ashbury district at the exact time the Zodiac was terrorizing the Bay Area.
- **The Manson Link:** Anger's original star for *Lucifer Rising* was Bobby Beausoleil, who later joined the **Manson Family**. This proves that Anger was only "one degree of separation" away from the most notorious California killers of that era.

The Verdict:

It is highly unlikely they were the same person, as their "artistic" outputs were so different—Anger was a flamboyant public figure, while the Zodiac was a shadow. However, it is **entirely possible** that the Zodiac was a consumer of Anger's underground publications and was influenced by the "dark Hollywood" aesthetic Anger popularized.

Would you like me to look into the specific **Occult symbols** the Zodiac used to see if they match the Thelema symbols used by Anger?

While there is no forensic evidence connecting the two, the **symbolic and thematic overlaps** between the Zodiac Killer's communications and the occult world inhabited by Kenneth Anger are striking.

1. The Cross-Circle Symbol

The Zodiac's most famous symbol—a circle with a cross through it—has several potential occult origins that match Anger's interests:

- **The Solar Cross:** A foundational symbol in ancient astrology and occultism, representing the sun and the four seasons. Anger, a devotee of the sun-god imagery in his film *Lucifer Rising*, frequently used solar and light-based motifs.
- **The Crossed Circle of Thelema:** In the religion of Thelema (founded by Aleister Crowley, whom Anger idolized), various geometric symbols like the unicursal hexagram represent the union of opposites. While not

an exact match, the Zodiac's symbol shares the "ritualistic geometry" common in the ceremonial magic Anger practiced.

- **The "Target" vs. The Sigil:** While many view the Zodiac symbol as a gun sight, occult theorists suggest it functions more like a magical sigil designed to "seal" his letters or "invoke" power, a technique central to Anger's ritualistic filmmaking.

2. "Slaves in Paradise" vs. Thelemic Doctrine
The Zodiac's claim that he was "collecting slaves for the afterlife" is one of the strongest "Crowley-esque" links:

- **The Afterlife Belief:** Some researchers have compared this to the Aeon of Horus, a Thelemic concept where the old moral laws are replaced by the "Will" of the individual.
- **Crowley's Influence:** Aleister Crowley wrote about "slaves" and "masters" in a metaphysical sense in *The Book of the Law*. Anger, who considered himself a prophet of Crowley, explored these themes of **dominance and submission** in films like *Scorpio Rising*.

3. The San Francisco Counter-Culture Link
During the peak of the Zodiac murders (1968–1969), Anger was a prominent figure in the **San Francisco occult scene**:

- **The Westerfeld Mansion:** Anger lived in this famous San Francisco landmark, where he hosted rituals and filmed *Invocation of My Demon Brother* (1969).
- **Social Overlap:** Anger was friends with **Anton LaVey** (founder of the Church of Satan) and **Bobby Beausoleil** (who joined the Manson Family). This suggests the Zodiac was operating in an environment saturated with the specific "dark occultism" Anger helped popularize.

Summary Comparison

Feature	Zodiac Killer	Kenneth Anger / Occult
Signature	Cross-Circle	Solar Cross / Sigils
Philosophy	"Slaves in Paradise"	Thelemic "Will" / Mastery
Method	Ritualized public taunting	Ritualized "Magick" cinema
Location	Bay Area (1968-1974)	San Francisco (Late 60s)

The most likely connection is that the Zodiac was a **consumer of the underground culture** Anger created—someone who read *Hollywood Babylon* and adopted the "aesthetic of the occult" to make his crimes seem more grandiose and mysterious.

Would you like to examine if any **Zodiac suspects** had documented interests in Aleister Crowley or the San Francisco occult scene?